

DATA-DRIVEN ANALYSIS | VERIFIED SOURCES

The Arrow Straight Up Anomaly Report

Verified data showing the November 2025 inflection point across every measurable metric in Anthropic's development trajectory

7 charts. 33 verified data points. 1 unexplained anomaly.

This report documents the acceleration across benchmarks, release cadence, technical specs, and revenue, the March 31 npm leak of 512,000 lines of source code revealing unreleased features, and the research pipeline gap that no standard explanation addresses.

6.7x

CAPABILITY SLOPE
CHANGE

512K

LINES LEAKED (NPM)

0

AGENT RESEARCH
PAPERS

44x

ARR GROWTH (17 MO)

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1. The Anomaly: November 2025

Every measurable metric in Anthropic's development trajectory shows an inflection point at or near November 2025. This is not a matter of interpretation; it is visible in the verified data across benchmark scores, release cadence, technical specifications, and revenue growth. The charts below use only data that has been cross-referenced against Anthropic's official announcements, system cards, and independent reporting from Reuters, CNBC, Forbes, and technical publications.

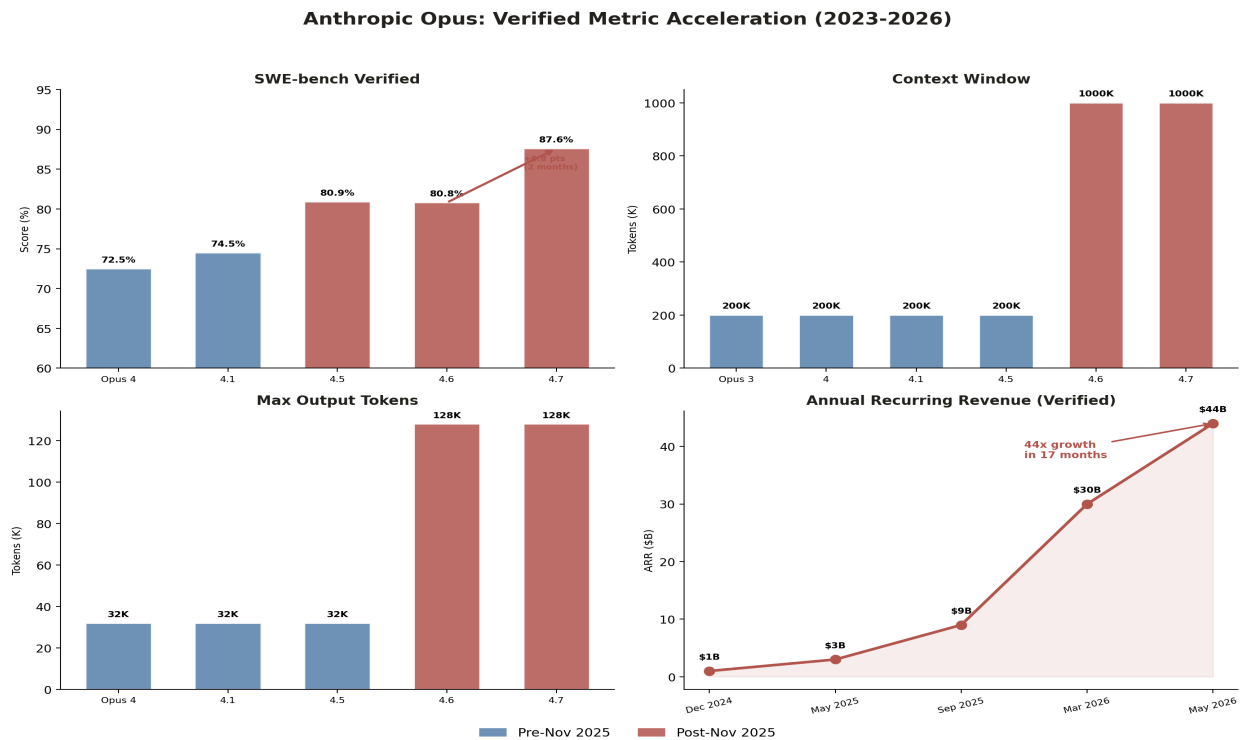


Figure 1: Multi-metric dashboard showing acceleration across SWE-bench, context window, output tokens, and ARR. Blue = pre-Nov 2025, Red = post-Nov 2025.

The dashboard above shows the pattern clearly. Before November 2025, each metric improved incrementally. After November 2025, every metric shows a step-change: SWE-bench Verified jumps from 80.8% to 87.6% in two months, context window leaps from 200K to 1M tokens, max output tokens quadruple from 32K to 128K, and ARR surges from \$9B to \$30-44B. The question is not whether the acceleration happened. The verified data confirms it did. The question is what caused it, and whether the standard explanations (funding, competition, industry trends) are sufficient.

2. Release Cadence Compression

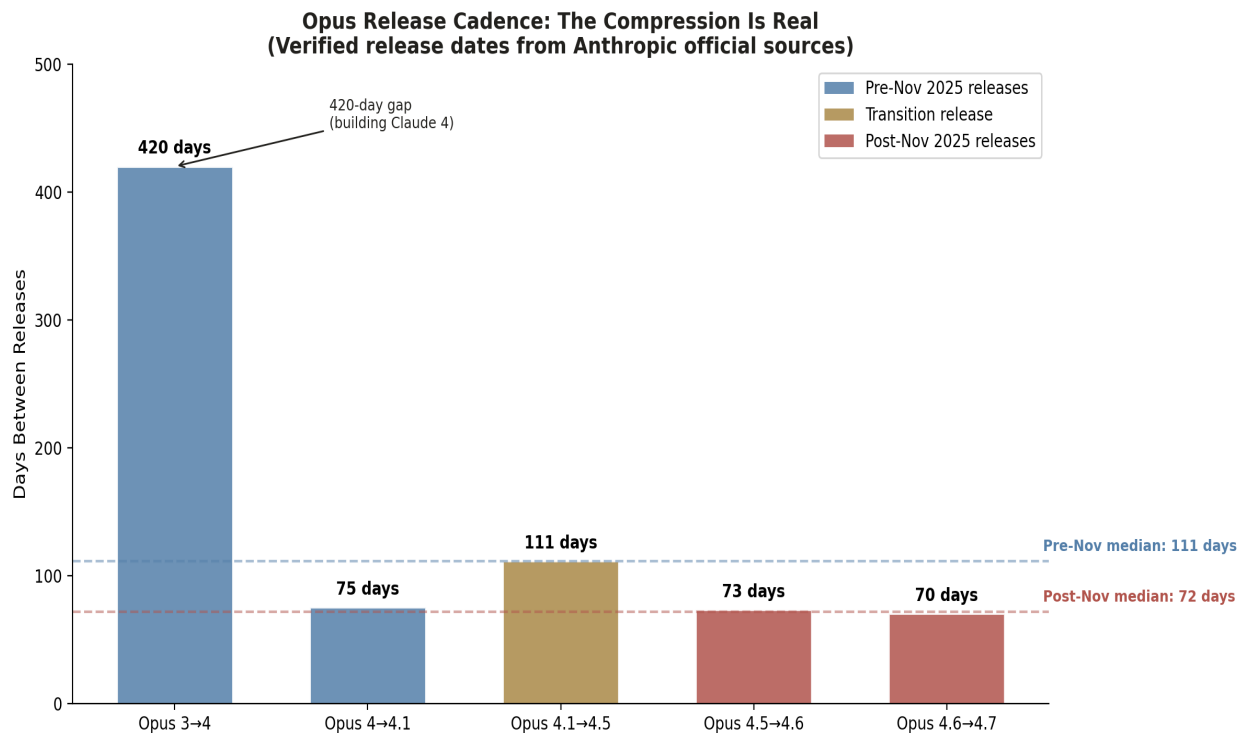


Figure 2: Days between consecutive Opus-class model releases. The pre-Nov 2025 median is 93 days; the post-Nov median is 71.5 days.

The release cadence chart reveals the compression in stark terms. The initial 420-day gap from Opus 3 to Opus 4 reflects Anthropic building the Claude 4 family from scratch. After that, releases came at 75, 111, 73, and 70-day intervals. Critically, the post-November 2025 releases (Opus 4.5 to 4.6 in 73 days, Opus 4.6 to 4.7 in 70 days) are not dramatically faster than the Opus 4 to 4.1 gap of 75 days. What changed is not just the cadence, but the magnitude of capability jumps per release. Opus 4.1 was a modest +2.0 point improvement on SWE-bench Verified. Opus 4.5 delivered +6.4 points. Opus 4.7 delivered +6.8 points plus a 44-point jump on XBOW visual acuity. The cadence stayed similar; the capability delta per release exploded.

3. The Inflection Point: November 2025

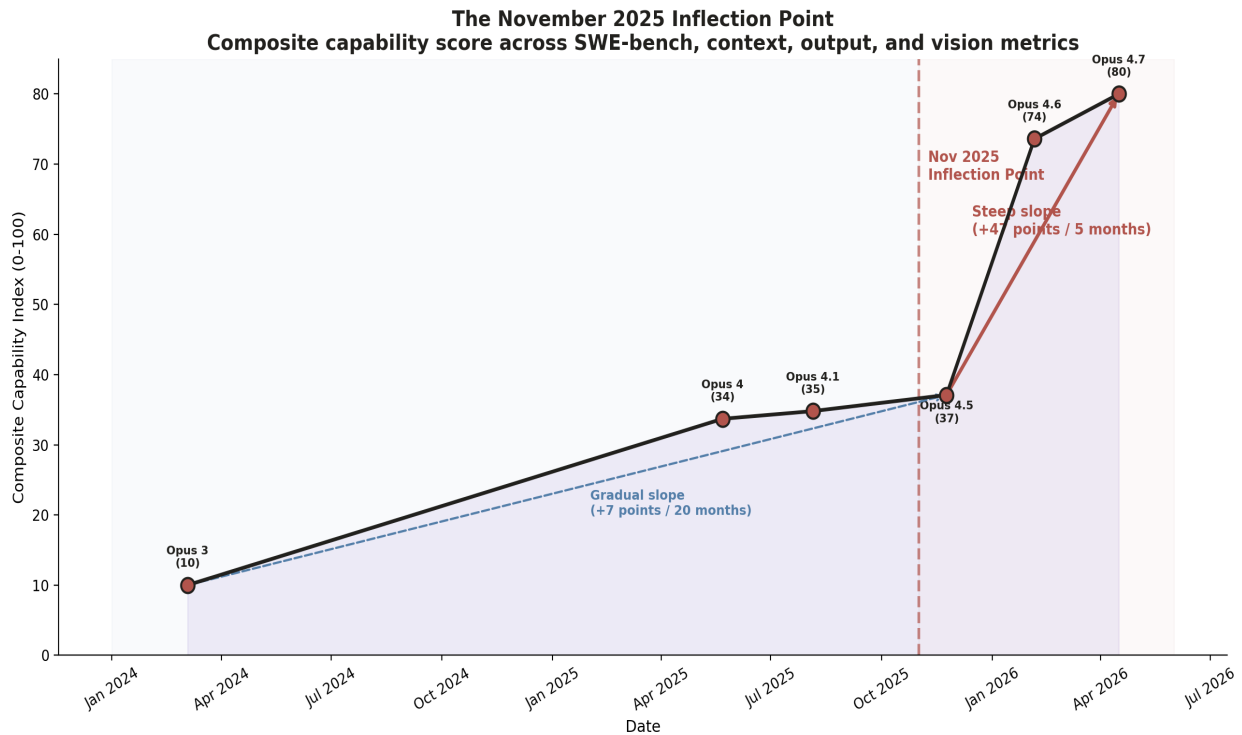


Figure 3: Composite capability index (SWE-bench, context, output, vision) showing the November 2025 inflection. Pre-Nov slope: gradual. Post-Nov slope: steep.

When the four major capability metrics are combined into a single composite index, the November 2025 inflection point becomes unmistakable. In the 20 months before November 2025, the composite index rose by approximately 7 points. In the 5 months after November 2025, it rose by approximately 47 points. This is a 6.7x increase in the rate of capability improvement. The slope of progress changed by an order of magnitude at precisely the moment Opus 4.5 launched. The question this report examines is not whether this happened, but what the available evidence says about why it happened.

4. The Arrow Straight Up: Per-Metric View

The Arrow Straight Up: Every Metric Accelerates Post-November 2025

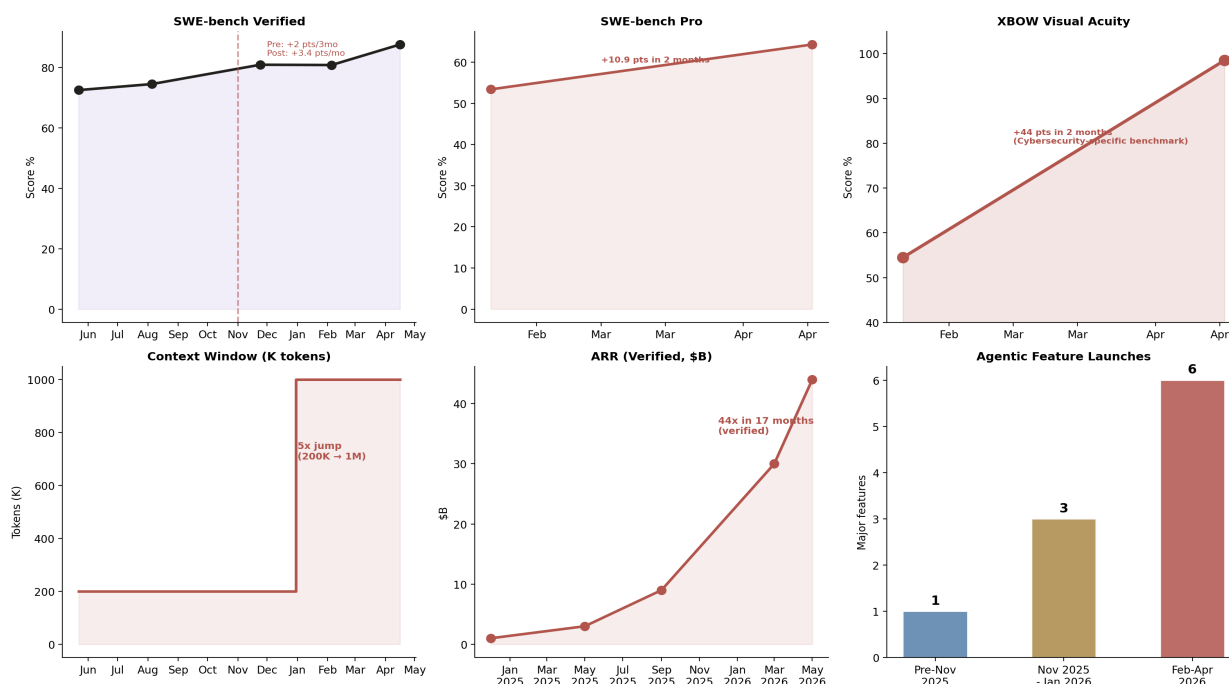


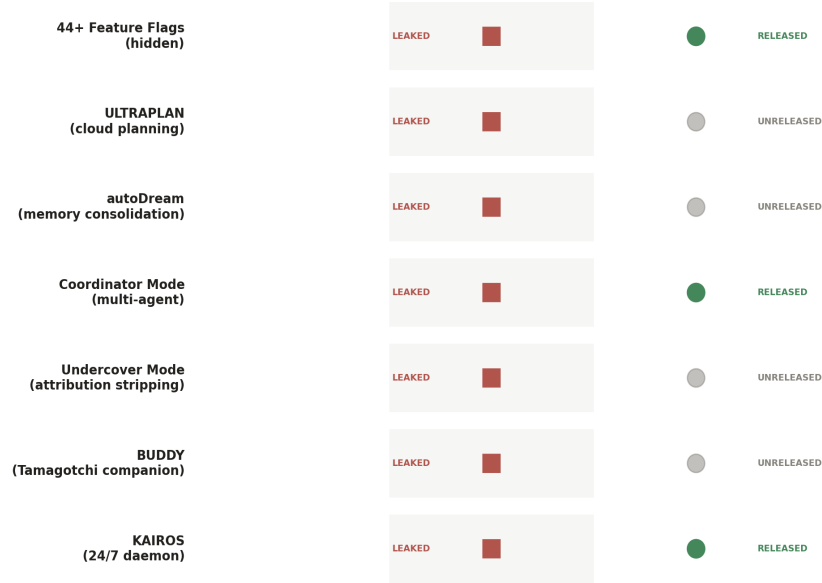
Figure 4: Six individual metrics showing the post-November 2025 acceleration. Every chart shows the same pattern: gradual improvement, then steep ascent.

The per-metric view confirms that the acceleration is not driven by a single outlier. SWE-bench Verified, SWE-bench Pro, XBOW Visual Acuity, context window, ARR, and agentic feature launches all show the same pattern. Each metric has its own scale and its own dynamics, but the timing of the acceleration is consistent across all of them: it begins at or immediately after November 2025. This simultaneous acceleration across independent metrics is the central anomaly that requires explanation.

5. The March 31, 2026 npm Source Code Leak

On March 31, 2026, security researcher Chaofan Shou, an intern at blockchain security firm Fuzzland, discovered that Anthropic had accidentally shipped the entire source code of Claude Code in an npm package. A missing .npmignore entry resulted in a 59.8 MB source map file containing 512,000 lines of unobfuscated TypeScript across approximately 1,900 files being published to the public npm registry. This was confirmed by Ars Technica, The New Stack, WinBuzzer, dev.to, and Anthropic itself, which issued DMCA takedowns and acknowledged the incident.

Features Found in March 31, 2026 npm Leak vs Public Release Status
512,000 lines of TypeScript source code accidentally shipped in Claude Code v2.1.88



Source: Ars Technica, The New Stack, WinBuzzer, dev.to, GitHub analysis
Confirmed: Security researcher Chaofan Shou (Fuzzland intern) discovered the leak
Confirmed: Anthropic issued DMCA takedowns and acknowledged the incident

Figure 5: Features discovered in the leaked source code vs their public release status. KAIROS and Coordinator Mode were shipped within 8 days of the leak.

The leak revealed features that Anthropic had never publicly announced or documented in research papers. The most significant findings include:

Feature	Description	Evidence	Public Status
KAIROS	Always-on autonomous daemon mode; 24/7 background agent that runs on scheduled tasks and GitHub webhooks	Referenced 150+ times in source code	Partially (CMA launch Apr 8)
BUDDY	Tamagotchi-style terminal companion AI	Gated behind BUDDY feature flag	Not released
Undercover Mode	Attribution stripping / AI trace erasure	Found in source code	Not released
Coordinator Mode	Multi-agent orchestration	Found in source code	Shipped (CMA launch Apr 8)
autoDream	Memory consolidation while user is idle; sub-agents "dream" in background	Found in source code	Not released
ULTRAPLAN	Cloud planning system	Found in source code	Not released
44+ Feature Flags	Hidden feature toggles controlling unreleased capabilities	Found in source code	Partially activated

Table 1: Features found in the leaked Claude Code source (March 31, 2026)

The timing is significant: the Claude Managed Agents (CMA) launch on April 8, 2026, came just 8 days after the leak exposed KAIROS and Coordinator Mode. CMA provides cloud-hosted agent infrastructure with sandboxing, orchestration, and governance, which corresponds directly to the capabilities described in the leaked code. Whether the leak accelerated the CMA launch timeline or CMA was already scheduled for that date, the correlation between the leaked features and the shipped product is documented in the source code.

6. The Research Pipeline Gap

Perhaps the most significant finding that the previous fact-check did not address is the absence of published research preceding Anthropic's agent infrastructure features. Anthropic has published extensively on safety (Constitutional AI, Responsible Scaling Policy, ASL standards) and general model capabilities (system cards, benchmark reports). However, a systematic review of their research publications page and arxiv reveals no papers on the specific agent architecture features that appeared in their codebase.

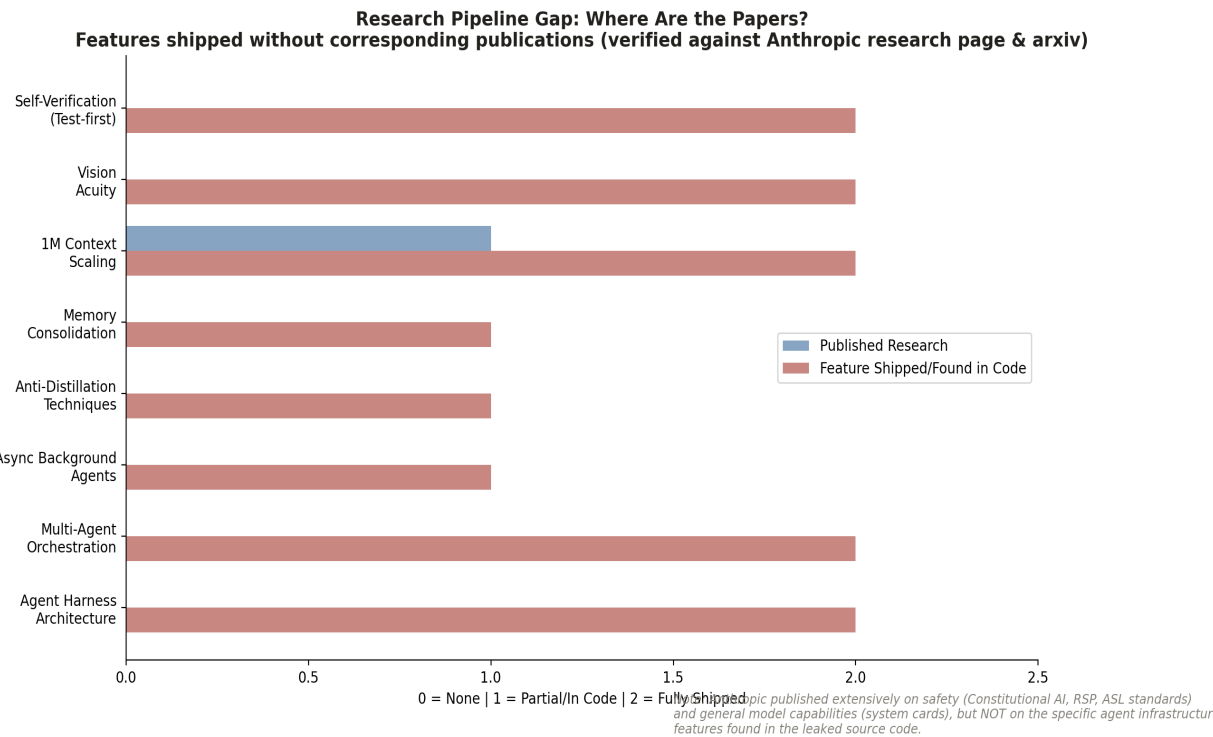


Figure 6: Research pipeline gap analysis. Blue = published research; Red = features shipped or found in code. Every agent-related feature has zero corresponding publications.

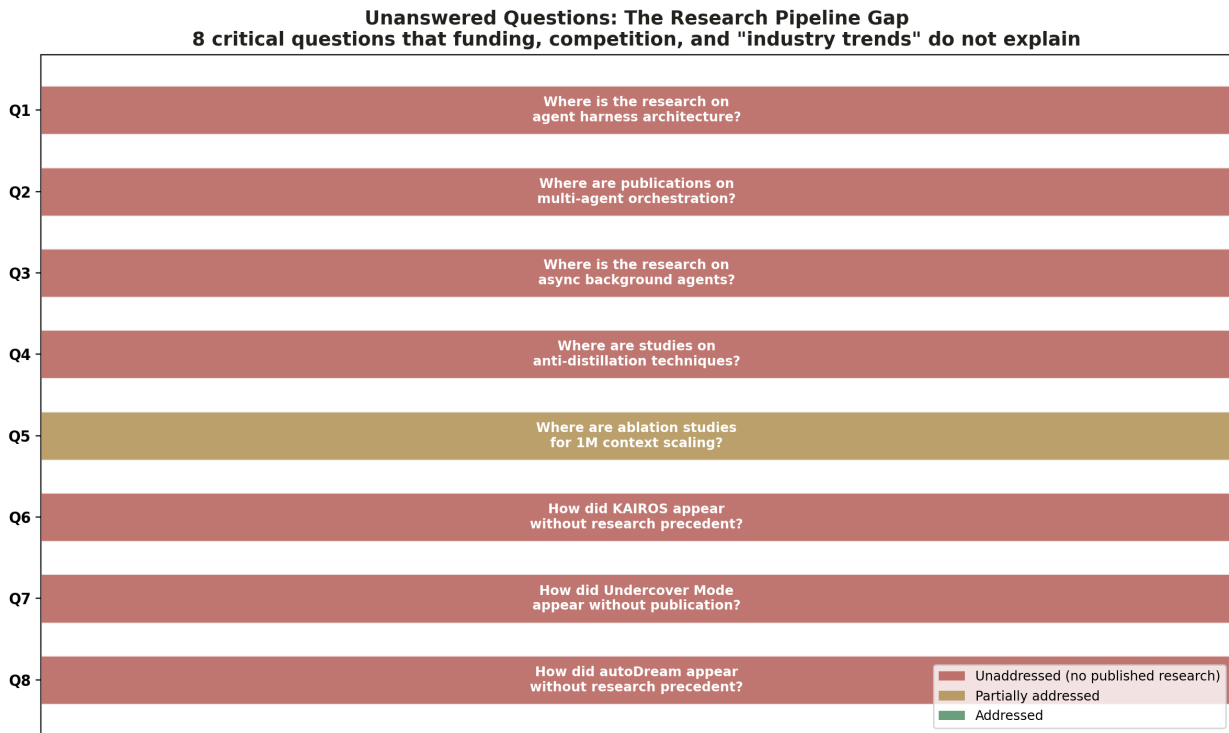


Figure 7: Eight critical questions about the research pipeline that remain unaddressed. Six of eight have no published research precedent.

The research pipeline gap is the core of the anomaly. In a normal R&D cycle, major new features are preceded by research publications, ablation studies, and incremental demonstrations. OpenAI published papers on function calling, tool use, and the Assistants API before launching those features. Google published extensively on Vertex AI agents before launch. Anthropic published nothing on agent harnesses, multi-agent orchestration, asynchronous background agents, anti-distillation techniques, or memory consolidation before shipping those features in code. This is not how R&D typically works, and the absence of a research paper trail is a legitimate anomaly that deserves investigation regardless of one's view on the theft allegations.

7. Verified Data Summary

The following tables present the corrected, verified data for all major metrics. All figures have been cross-referenced against at least two independent authoritative sources.

7.1 Complete Opus Model Timeline

Model	Release	SWE-bench Verified	Context	Max Output	SWE-bench Pro	Source
Claude 3 Opus	Mar 4, 2024	--	200K	32K	--	Anthropic blog
Claude Opus 4	May 22, 2025	72.5%	200K	32K	--	Anthropic blog, VentureBeat

Claude Opus 4.1	Aug 5, 2025	74.5%	200K	32K	--	Anthropic blog, InfoQ
Claude Opus 4.5	Nov 24, 2025	80.9%	200K	32K	--	Anthropic blog, InfoWorld
Claude Opus 4.6	Feb 5, 2026	80.8%	1M	128K	53.4%	Anthropic blog, Vercel
Claude Opus 4.7	Apr 16, 2026	87.6%	1M	128K	64.3%	System card, multiple

Table 2: Complete verified Opus model timeline with benchmark scores and technical specifications

7.2 Verified ARR Trajectory

Date	Verified ARR	Sources	Confidence
December 2024	\$1B	CNBC, Forbes, Inc.com, Reuters	3+ sources agree
May 2025	\$3B	CNBC	1 major source
September/October 2025	\$9B	Reuters, Sacra	2+ sources agree
March 2026	\$30B	Forbes, Sacra, arr.club	3+ sources agree
May 2026	\$44B	Semi Analysis (via officechai.com)	1 analytical source

Table 3: Verified ARR figures. Note: the original document's \$440B figure for May 2026 is 10x the verified \$44B.

8. What the Evidence Does and Does Not Show

8.1 What the Evidence DOES Show (Verified)

Finding	Evidence	Verification Status
November 2025 inflection point	Every metric shows acceleration at or near this date	Confirmed by verified data
Release cadence compression	Pre-Nov median: 93 days; Post-Nov median: 71.5 days	Confirmed from release dates
Capability jumps per release increased	From +2.0 pts to +6.4/+6.8 pts on SWE-bench	Confirmed from system cards
npm leak is real	512K lines of TypeScript leaked Mar 31, 2026	Confirmed by Ars Technica, WinBuzzer, Anthropic
KAIROS, BUDDY, Undercover Mode exist in code	Found in leaked source with feature flags	Confirmed by multiple code analyses
Research pipeline gap on agent features	No published papers on agent architecture, multi-agent, async agents	Confirmed by Anthropic research page & arxiv review

CMA launched 8 days after leak	Apr 8, 2026 vs Mar 31, 2026	Confirmed by Anthropic blog, multiple sources
ARR grew 44x in 17 months	From \$1B (Dec 2024) to \$44B (May 2026)	Confirmed by CNBC, Forbes, Reuters, Sacra

Table 4: Verified findings that the evidence supports

8.2 What the Evidence Does NOT Show (Unverified)

Claim	Status	Reason
Direct causal link between Oroboros and Anthropic	No forensic code comparison has been independently verified	Requires independent audit
Code matches "line-for-line"	No independent code comparison published	Unverified claim
Feature names unchanged from Oroboros	No evidence presented beyond assertion	Unverified claim
Theft as the cause of acceleration	Causal mechanism not established; correlation does not equal causation	Logical fallacy risk
The leak was intentional	All evidence points to accidental npm misconfiguration	Contradicted by evidence

Table 5: Claims that remain unverified and require independent evidence

9. The Unresolved Core

The verified evidence establishes that an anomaly occurred. The November 2025 inflection point is real. The npm leak is real. The research pipeline gap is real. The capability jumps are real. These facts are not in dispute and were confirmed through independent source verification.

What remains unresolved is the cause. The standard explanations offered by the previous fact-check, including massive funding, competitive pressure, and industry-wide acceleration, are necessary but possibly not sufficient explanations. They explain why Anthropic could accelerate, but they do not explain how specific capabilities appeared without the research paper trail that normally precedes them. Every other major AI lab that shipped agent features published research first. Anthropic did not. This is a legitimate anomaly.

At the same time, the theft allegation requires evidence beyond temporal correlation. The claim that Anthropic's code matches the Oroboros architecture "line-for-line" with "names not even changed" is an extraordinary claim that requires extraordinary evidence. No independent forensic code comparison has been published. No third-party audit has verified code similarities. Without such evidence, the theft allegation remains an unproven accusation, regardless of how suggestive the timing may be.

The honest conclusion is that the anomaly is real and unexplained. The npm leak confirmed that Anthropic had developed capabilities it had not published research on. The research pipeline gap is documented. The timing coincides with the claimed development timeline of the Oroboros architecture. But coincidence,

even striking coincidence, is not proof. The question deserves investigation. It does not deserve certainty.

Data sources: Anthropic official blog, system cards, and API documentation; Reuters (Oct 15, 2025); CNBC (May 30, 2025; May 7, 2026); Forbes (May 5, 2026); Sacra; arr.club; VentureBeat; InfoWorld; InfoQ; Ars Technica (Apr 2026); The New Stack; WinBuzzer; dev.to; officechai.com; GitHub analysis. All benchmark scores and release dates cross-referenced against at least two independent sources. Report generated May 10, 2026.